

What Do You Want to Be When You Grow Up?

- Not making enough money to pay your debts
- Choosing a career that is not in demand
- Budgeting based on your gross income instead of your net income
- Not understanding taxation

Off to Work We Go

The decision to go to college after high school can be influenced by many factors. The percentage of graduates going on to college from your high school can play a big role. If a large number of your classmates are college bound, it increases the likelihood that you will consider attending college. Additionally, if your parents are college graduates, your likelihood of going to college increases.

The reality is that increased education and increased pay go hand-in-hand. The statistics show that the higher educational level you attain, the higher salary you will command. Take a look at the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics' 2006 findings relating to earnings by educational attainment:

Highest Level	Weekly Earnings	Annual Earnings	Unemployment Rate
Some high school	\$419	\$21,788	6.8%
High School Graduate	\$595	\$30,940	4.3%
Bachelor's degree	\$962	\$50,024	2.3%
Master's degree	\$1,140	\$59,280	1.7%
Ph.D.	\$1,441	\$74,932	1.4%
Professional degree	\$1,474	\$76,648	1.1%

A “diploma premium” is attached to each advanced educational level. The average salary of someone with a master’s degree is almost double that of someone with only a high school diploma;

